



MARKETING LABS · STRATEGY & GROWTH

BCG Growth-Share Matrix

See where each offer sits before deciding where to invest.

Interactive BCG Growth-Share Matrix for product and business portfolio planning.

Includes: framework reference · guidance by stage · printable worksheet

BCG Growth-Share Matrix: reference

INTERACTIVE PORTFOLIO-STRATEGY PROTOTYPE

Plot products, brands or business units against market growth and relative market share. The matrix can make portfolio conversations more concrete: which offers may deserve investment, which can fund development, which need a deliberate decision and which may need repositioning, harvesting or exit.

Use the BCG matrix as a prompt, not an automatic strategy. Share and growth are imperfect proxies for cash generation, attractiveness and strategic value. Consider profitability, customer need, capability, risk, competitive dynamics, mission, switching costs and future scenarios—especially in smaller or digital businesses.

Portfolio growth-share map

Select a portfolio bubble to inspect the assumptions, strategic note and possible decision prompts.

Star: invest to sustain leadership

Question Mark: choose to invest or exit

Cash Cow: sustain and fund priorities

Dog: harvest, reposition or divest

MARKET GROWTH RATE

HIGH GROWTH

LOW GROWTH

HIGH GROWTH · HIGH SHARE

Stars

Protect and develop leadership; growing markets can still require substantial investment.

HIGH GROWTH · LOW SHARE

Question Marks

Choose selectively: invest to build a credible position, reposition or exit.

LOW GROWTH · HIGH SHARE

Cash Cows

Maintain health and cash generation while funding other strategic priorities.

LOW GROWTH · LOW SHARE

Dogs

Consider harvesting, redesigning, repositioning, partnering or exiting—based on wider value.

RELATIVE MARKET SHARE: HIGH (LEFT) TO LOW (RIGHT)

Using the growth-share matrix well

- Treat growth and share as directional estimates. Document sources and refresh them regularly.

- Define the market boundary first; a narrow or broad definition can move an item between quadrants.
- Use thresholds that suit your industry rather than defaulting to 10% growth and 1.0x share.
- Look beyond two axes: profitability, capability, customer value, risk and strategic fit all matter.
- Balance the portfolio: Question Marks and Stars need cash that Cash Cows and careful Dogs can help provide.

BCG Growth-Share Matrix: your canvas

Print this page or fill it in by hand. The interactive lab asks the same questions.

Product, brand or business unit

For example: Enterprise service, product line or business unit

Strategic note

Capture the context behind the numbers: customer value, competitive advantage, constraints or strategic rationale.

Market growth rate

Use overall market growth, not the individual product's revenue growth.

-10

40

Relative market share

A useful convention is your market share divided by the largest competitor's share; above 1.0 indicates leadership.

0.1

2.5

High-growth threshold

High-share threshold

Planning aid, not advice. Test assumptions with evidence and consider privacy, accessibility, fairness and sustainability before acting.